ECLECTIC TIMES

SMART TECH - RAW TALENT - PURE CAMPUS CULTURE

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HONOURING OUR LEGENDS: MAHATMA GANDHI AND LAL BAHADUR SHASTRI JAYANTI

On October 2nd, 2026, IIIT Pune came together to magnificently celebrate the enduring legacies of Mahatma Gandhi and Lal Bahadur Shastri. This grand tribute was marked by profound, thought-provoking discussions by 2nd Year Students, Garima Arya and Kavya Srivastava, that allowed students to deeply reflect on Bapu's unwavering commitment to truth and non-violence, as well as Shastriji's remarkable simplicity and resilient leadership.

The campus atmosphere was beautifully transformed by vibrant, intricate rangoli art meticulously crafted by the Rang club, which set a visually striking and patriotic tone for the day. The audience was captivated by soul-stirring, self-composed poetry delivered by the Eclectic club members, eloquently capturing the essence of our nation's history and the sacrifices of its leaders. Adding to the immense cultural richness of the celebration, Shubholaxmi Adhikary (First Year) enchanted everyone with a melodious and deeply moving rendition of the patriotic Bengali song 'Utho Go Bharata Lakshmi'.

The memorable event was gracefully concluded with an inspiring address by Director Prof. Vineet Kansal. He motivated the student body with the visionary slogan, "Jai Vigyan, Jai Anusandhaan," urging future innovators to build a self-reliant India.

THE GRAND GANESHOTSAV

Organised with immense zeal and dedication by the Aarambh club, IIIT Pune witnessed a truly spectacular three-day Ganesh Chaturthi celebration that brought the entire student community together. An aura of pure devotion echoed through the campus, anchored by soul-stirring morning and evening aartis that filled the air with spiritual tranquility and reverence. These sacred rituals were seamlessly followed by vibrant, interactive games and joyous festivities that sparked laughter, teamwork, and strong camaraderie among peers.

In a beautiful display of unity and tradition, a mesmerizing sea of radiant orange kurtas completely enveloped the institute, painting the campus in pure festive fervour and shared devotion. The grand finale on day three elevated the cultural excitement to entirely new heights. It featured a compelling, thought-provoking street play performed by the Abhinay club and profound, reflective poetry recited by the Eclectic club.

After hours of exuberant dancing and unbridled fun, the magnificent celebration culminated in a majestic and deeply emotional Visarjan. Students bid a heartfelt farewell to the deity, leaving everyone with cherished college memories and a lingering sense of divine blessing.

VLSI DESIGN MICRO CREDITS PROGRAM: DR. VIRENDRA SINGH, IIT BOMBAY

Under the Micro Credits Program (MCP), Dr. Virendra Singh from IIT Bombay visited the IIIT Pune on September 2nd, 2026 to deliver a lecture on Very Large Scale Integration (VLSI) Design. The session introduced students to modern semiconductor architectures and industry practices. Dr. Singh also led an interactive session with faculty members focused on joint research and curriculum enhancement.

MACHINE LEARNING MICRO CREDITS PROGRAM: PROF. SOURANGSHU BHATTACHARYA, IIT KGP

The Micro Credits Program featured a session led by Prof. Sourangshu Bhattacharya from IIT Kharagpur on September 27th–28th, 2026. Prof. Bhattacharya conducted an intensive, seven-hour lecture on Supervised Machine Learning, providing students with deep theoretical grounding and practical insights into predictive modeling and algorithmic frameworks. The session strengthened student's understanding of machine learning applications and their relevance to real-world problem-solving across diverse domains.

CRYPTOGRAPHY MICRO CREDITS PROGRAM: PROF. SOMITRA SANADHYA, IIT KANPUR

As part of the Micro Credits Program (MCP), which brings faculty members from other institutions into student classrooms, IIIT Pune hosted Prof. Somitra Sanadhya from IIT Kanpur on October 7th, 2026. Prof. Sanadhya led an intensive two-day session covering the foundational concepts of cryptography, Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC), and quantum-resilient security. This initiative directly supports Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4) for Quality Education, SDG 9 for Innovation, and SDG 17 for Partnerships for the Goals.

IIIT PUNE PARTICIPATES IN CROSS-INSTITUTIONAL ENGAGEMENT AT IIT BOMBAY

A delegation from the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT), Pune recently participated in a cross-institutional engagement at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay. The engagement included participants from IIM Nagpur, AIIMS Nagpur, VNIT Nagpur, ITRA Jamnagar, ICMR-National Institute of Virology, NIPER Ahmedabad, and other leading academic and research institutions, in addition to IIIT Pune.

The visit focused on gaining insights into the IIT Bombay Innovation Ecosystem, with meaningful interactions at the ASPIRE IITB Research Park Foundation and the Society for Innovation and Entrepreneurship (SINE), IIT Bombay. For IIIT Pune, the engagement served as a valuable platform for exchanging ideas, exploring potential avenues for collaboration, and understanding how institutions from diverse disciplines can work together to foster innovation.

Following the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) signed between IIT Bombay and IIIT Pune on July 23th, 2026, this engagement marked a significant milestone in the growing partnership between the two institutions. It opened avenues for exploring collaborative research opportunities, knowledge exchange, and innovation-driven initiatives. The engagement lays the groundwork for future academic and research collaborations aimed at fostering technological advancement and strengthening institutional ties.

INDUSTRY INSIGHTS

ENGINEERING, INNOVATION & PROBLEM SOLVING: MR. MADHAB SHARMA

As part of its continuous effort to connect academic learning with industry practice, the Indian Institute of Information Technology Pune (IIIT Pune) hosted Mr. Madhab Sharma, Senior Software Engineer at Advanced Micro Devices India (AMD India) and former engineer at Qualcomm India, for an exclusive expert session on campus.

Mr. Sharma delivered an insightful address titled “Engineering, Innovation & Problem Solving,” drawing upon his extensive experience in high-performance computing and semiconductor software development. He highlighted how engineering fundamentals can be transformed into impactful real-world projects, emphasizing structured problem-solving, system architecture design, and industry-level innovation practices.
Following the lecture, he engaged in interactive discussions with students and faculty on career development, emerging software trends, and aligning academic coursework with current industry demands.

This engagement directly supports Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4) for Quality Education, SDG 8 for Decent Work and Economic Growth, SDG 9 for Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure, and SDG 17 for Partnerships for the Goals.

ACM STUDENT CHAPTER: DR. R. VENKATESWARAN

We welcomed Dr. R. Venkateswaran, former researcher at Bell Laboratories (Bell Labs) and Lucent Technologies, for an insightful interaction on campus centered on academic development and computing research outreach.
The strategic discussions focused on accelerating the growth and impact of the Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) Student Chapter at IIIT Pune.

Key deliberations centered on strengthening student engagement through dedicated industry mentorship programs. Additionally, Dr. Venkateswaran and institute members explored collaborative frameworks for research outreach to cultivate a vibrant ecosystem for technical innovation and computing excellence.

This collaborative engagement directly aligns with Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG 4) for Quality Education, SDG 9 for Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure, and SDG 17 for Partnerships for the Goals.

ACM INFORMATION SESSION

On September 29th, 2026, IIIT Pune hosted an Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) Information Session in the campus Auditorium which introduced students to the global ACM organization and the institute's dedicated Student Chapter. Participants learned about the chapter's upcoming technical workshops, networking events, and peer-learning initiatives planned for the academic year. A major focus was on active participation, detailing how students can officially join, lead events, and collaborate on technical projects. By encouraging students to leverage platforms like the ACM chapter, the Institute aims to foster leadership, teamwork, and professional confidence alongside traditional academic learning.

HOLISTIC GROWTH BEYOND ACADEMICS

In an effort to foster holistic student development beyond standard academic curricula, IIIT Pune conducted four dedicated wellness sessions organized by the ManSamvaad Wellness Club. Designed to cultivate mental clarity, emotional resilience, and self-awareness, the series focused on nurturing the mind, soul, and overarching life purpose of the student community.

The initiative featured four structured modules: "The Game of Life," "Discover Inner Self," "Discover Ultimate Genius," and a thought-provoking session titled "Who Is the Master: You or Your Mobile?" Through these interactive discussions, students explored practical frameworks for mindfulness, self-discovery, cognitive focus, and maintaining healthy boundaries with digital technology.
By prioritizing psychological health alongside technical training, the program highlights the institutional commitment of IIIT Pune to developing well-rounded engineers and leaders. This effort directly supports Sustainable Development Goal 3 (SDG 3) for Good Health and Well-Being, SDG 4 for Quality Education, and SDG 10 for Reduced Inequalities.

BINGHAMTON UNIVERSITY VISITS IIIT PUNE

The Indian Institute of Information Technology, Pune was thrilled to host a delegation from Binghamton University on September 1st, 2026.

The session kicked off with an expert talk delivered by Prof. Aravind Prakash on leveraging artificial intelligence for Robust and Resilient Software Systems. This talk gave students a concrete understanding of how machine learning research is applied to production-grade systems security, a domain of growing national and global importance. This insightful talk was followed by Ms. Johanna Brozinsky, Director of Graduate Recruitment, Binghamton University, who engaged with IIIT Pune students on post-graduate study opportunities, programmes, scholarships, and pathways at Binghamton University.

This session reflected IIIT Pune's growing spirit of global thinking and international collaboration. We look forward to further interaction with the students and faculty at Binghamton University

INDIA-GERMANY CONNECT: DAAD INDIA WORKSHOP AT IIT KHARAGPUR

The Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Pune was honoured to be part of a distinguished cohort at the Deutscher Akademischer Austauschdienst International Higher Education Dialogue (DAAD iHED) workshop.

The workshop focused on “Internationalisation at Indian Higher Education Institutions – Cooperation, Management and Strategic Partnerships.”

The workshop was held on September 8th and 9th, 2026 at the Indian Institute of Technology(IIT), Kharagpur. The event brought together 30 internationalization professors from leading higher education institutions (HEIs) across India, and alumni of the DAAD German Academic Exchange Service – one of the world’s leading organizations for international academic excellence. Some of the key themes discussed were; best practices for cooperation management and project development, future Indo-German strategic partnerships, and frameworks for research, student and faculty exchange.

This workshop triggered an exciting future of academic partnership among Indian and German institutions, including IIIT Pune.

MINISTRY OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS: INDUSTRY START-UP ENGAGEMENT

In September 2026, the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Pune participated in the "Engaging Emerging Start-Ups in AI, Healthcare & Life Sciences" event, co-organized by India's Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) and Europe's hub.brussels. The gathering brought together industry leaders and entrepreneurs to discuss cross-border collaboration and the role of emerging technologies in solving societal challenges.

Key speakers included MEA officials Mr. Swapnil Thorat and Mr. Ajay Kumar, alongside Mrs. Manisha Verma from the Government of Maharashtra, who highlighted state and national efforts to foster innovation. Third-year students Anshika Dhuria and Manas Vyas represented IIIT Pune, networking with global innovators to explore future collaborations. Their participation underscores the Institute's dedication to connecting students with international entrepreneurial platforms, helping them translate classroom research into real-world, global impact.

ALUMNI SPEAKS: A STUDENT-LED INITIATIVE BRINGS IIIT PUNE ALUMNI BACK TO CAMPUS

The Alumni Cell of the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Pune launched the first-ever edition of "Alumni Speaks" on September 29th, 2026. The session began at 16:30 in the Auditorium. It was a completely student-led initiative, created to build a stronger and more connected student community through meaningful interaction between seniors, juniors and alumni.

The inaugural speaker was Mr. Darshan Lokhande, a proud IIIT Pune alumnus and Software Engineer at Google. At Google, he works on Web Indexing and Information Retrieval systems that operate at massive scale. With nearly four years of experience across Google and Nutanix, he has contributed to and improved large-scale backend systems. A Computer Science graduate of IIIT Pune, he is also a three-time International Collegiate Programming Contest (ICPC) Regionalist, which reflects his strong expertise in algorithms and problem-solving.

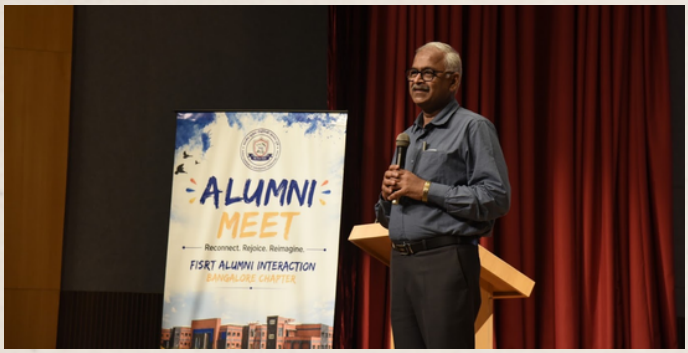
Mr. Lokhande shared insights from his journey, his career experiences, industry expectations, the opportunities ahead and the transition from college to the professional world. It was far more than a series of stories. Students brought their questions and received practical, honest guidance from a senior who has successfully made the journey from IIIT Pune to Google. The conversation covered placements, career opportunities and everything students wished to ask openly.

The energy in the room showed how much students value such conversations. The Alumni Cell is thrilled by the response and is determined to make "Alumni Speaks" a regular feature of campus life. It plans to host many more editions and to bring more alumni from diverse fields back to campus, so that every student has a senior to learn from.

IIITP ALUMNI MEET: BANGALORE CHAPTER

The Bangalore Chapter of IIIT Pune hosted its Alumni Meet on September 5th, 2026, celebrating the warmth, lasting bonds, and shared pride that define the IIIT Pune community.

The gathering was graced by Director Prof. Vineet Kansal, whose presence reaffirmed the Institute's commitment to staying connected with its graduates. He was joined by Dr. Bhupendra Singh (CSE), Dr. Nagendra Kushwaha (ECE), and Associate Dean Dr. Sanjeev Sharma. Dr. Chandrakant Guled, Dr. Kaptan Singh, and Ms. Anagha Khiste also attended, alongside other faculty and staff members. The Training and Placement Cell was represented by Mr. Kedar Bhogshetti and his team.



The evening brought together alumni building impactful careers and ventures across technology, finance, entrepreneurship, and research. Their experiences reflected the spirit of excellence that IIIT Pune continues to foster. Conversations between alumni and faculty rekindled fond memories of campus life while opening discussions about the Institute's growth and future opportunities.

The Institute extends its heartfelt gratitude to all alumni, faculty, and staff who made the gathering memorable. The meet served as a reminder that the IIIT Pune community extends far beyond campus, growing stronger through the achievements, connections, and contributions of its graduates.

राजभाषा महोत्सव–हिन्दी माह, सितंबर 2026: IIIT पुणे में भाषा और संस्कृति का उत्सव

भारतीय सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान (IIIT), पुणे में राजभाषा के प्रति जागरूकता बढ़ाने और हिंदी के अधिकाधिक प्रयोग को प्रोत्साहित करने के उद्देश्य से सितंबर माह में 'राजभाषा महोत्सव–हिन्दी माह, 2026' का भव्य आयोजन किया गया। निदेशक प्रो. विनीत कंसल के मार्गदर्शन में, इस महोत्सव का उद्घाटन मुख्य अतिथि प्रो. वीरेंद्र सिंह (IIT बॉम्बे) के कर–कमलों द्वारा संपन्न हुआ।

इस महोत्सव का शानदार शुभारंभ 2 सितंबर 2026 को संगीत क्लब 'साज़' और राजभाषा कार्यान्वयन समिति के संयुक्त तत्वावधान में आयोजित "अंताक्षरी: साज़ का संगम" प्रतियोगिता के साथ हुआ। पूरे माह के दौरान संस्थान में उत्सव का माहौल रहा, जिसके अंतर्गत अंताक्षरी, कविता, निबंध, वाद–विवाद, क्विज़, पोस्टर मेकिंग और स्लोगन राइटिंग जैसी विभिन्न प्रतियोगिताओं का सफलतापूर्वक आयोजन किया गया।

राजभाषा महोत्सव–हिंदी माह 2026 के अंतर्गत आयोजित विभिन्न प्रतियोगिताओं के पुरस्कार विजेताओं एवं संबद्ध छात्र क्लबों की अद्यतन सूची इस प्रकार रही:

1. अंताक्षरी प्रतियोगिता ; संबद्ध छात्र क्लब: साज़
   - प्रथम पुरस्कार: आयुष कुमार, धीरज कुमार, धनराज, मोहम्मद रयान, यश यादव
   - द्वितीय पुरस्कार: देव कृष्ण, ए. संजना, अदिति मानिकंतन, यशराज सिंह, मुकुल रावत
   - तृतीय पुरस्कार (संयुक्त विजेता):
     - Faculty Team–1: डॉ. जतिन मजीठिया, डॉ. हबिला बसुमतारी, डॉ. संज्ञा चाकी, डॉ. अनघा खिस्ते
     - Faculty Team–2: डॉ. सोनम मौर्य, श्रीमती अनुप्रिया, श्रीमती अनुपमा, डॉ. प्रियंका जोशी
   - प्रोत्साहन पुरस्कार:
     - Team–1: शिवा भारती, शिवांजलि चन्ना, कामाक्षी ललवानी, रुतुजा रांदिवे
     - Team–2: हर्ष विश्वकर्मा, यश्वी चावला, मिनेश सिहरा, अथर्व वर्मा, जतिन

2. हिंदी सामान्य ज्ञान एवं राजभाषा प्रश्नोत्तरी ; संबद्ध छात्र क्लब: इकलेक्टिक
   - प्रथम पुरस्कार: डॉ. सोनम मौर्य
   - द्वितीय पुरस्कार: श्री आनंद मोहन
   - तृतीय पुरस्कार: श्री आदर्श चौधरी
   - प्रोत्साहन पुरस्कार: सुश्री अनुपमा अरुण, सार्थक शुक्ला

3. हिंदी निबंध लेखन प्रतियोगिता
   संबद्ध छात्र क्लब: इकलेक्टिक
   - प्रथम पुरस्कार: गौरवेंद्र सिंह
   - द्वितीय पुरस्कार: गरिमा आर्या
   - तृतीय पुरस्कार: अतिशय
   - प्रोत्साहन पुरस्कार: ऋषुराज सिंह, सुप्रिया जाधव

4. पोस्टर मेकिंग एवं स्लोगन राइटिंग प्रतियोगिता ; संबद्ध छात्र क्लब: रंग
   - प्रथम पुरस्कार: श्रुति सोलंकी
   - द्वितीय पुरस्कार: वरुण विजय चौरसिया
   - तृतीय पुरस्कार: दन्नेश्वरी
   - प्रोत्साहन पुरस्कार: शिव अस्मिता साठे, अमोलिका गुप्ता

5. राजभाषा हिंदी में कार्यालयीन टिप्पणी एवं प्रारूपण प्रतियोगिता
   - प्रथम पुरस्कार: आंशिक धुरिया
   - द्वितीय पुरस्कार: डॉ. प्रियांक जैन
   - तृतीय पुरस्कार: डॉ. सोनम मौर्य
   - प्रोत्साहन पुरस्कार: संकल्प कुमार, सुश्री श्वेता रंजन, सुश्री पल्लवी रामदास साने

6. हिंदी वाद–विवाद प्रतियोगिता ; संबद्ध छात्र क्लब: इकलेक्टिक
   - प्रथम पुरस्कार: श्रेयस कुमार
   - द्वितीय पुरस्कार: आनिरुद्ध रेड्डी
   - तृतीय पुरस्कार: आकाश यादव
   - प्रोत्साहन पुरस्कार: डॉ. सोनम मौर्य, श्रीमती अनुप्रिया, श्री रुद्राक्ष

साज़ का संगम एवं राष्ट्रीय कवि सम्मेलन: सुर और शब्दों की एक अविस्मरणीय शाम

'राजभाषा महोत्सव (हिंदी माह – 2026)' के अंतर्गत 11 सितंबर 2026 को "साज़ का संगम एवं राष्ट्रीय कवि सम्मेलन" सफलतापूर्वक संपन्न हुआ। शाम 6:30 बजे संस्थान में आयोजित यह भव्य कार्यक्रम काव्य, संगीत, हास्य व संस्कृति का एक अनूठा संगम था।

दीप प्रज्वलन के पश्चात, संगीत क्लब 'साज़' के द्वितीय वर्ष के छात्रों, चिन्मय जैन, आयुष कुमार, सिद्धार्थ रस्तोगी और हर्ष विश्वकर्मा, की रूहानी प्रस्तुति तथा अन्य छात्रों (राजन और ऋषु) के शानदार काव्य–पाठ ने महफ़िल में नई जान फूँक दी। इसके बाद देश के मूर्धन्य रचनाकारों, श्री पवन आगरी, श्री ओम प्रकाश कल्याणे, डॉ. गणेश शंकर श्रीवास्तव, डॉ. विनम्र सेन सिंह और श्री शंभू शिखर ने मंच को समृद्ध किया। इन दिग्गज कवियों ने अपनी हास्य–व्यंग्य और विचारोत्तेजक कविताओं से श्रोताओं को पूरी तरह मंत्रमुग्ध कर दिया।

इस पूरी सांगीतिक और काव्यात्मक शाम को 'इकलेक्टिक' क्लब की द्वितीय वर्ष की छात्रा गरिमा आर्या के कुशल मंच संचालन ने एक सुंदर सूत्र में पिरोए रखा। संकाय सदस्यों, कर्मचारियों और विद्यार्थियों की सपरिवार उपस्थिति तथा अंत में आयोजित रात्रिभोज के साथ इस मधुर शाम का शानदार समापन हुआ।

SWACHHATA HI SEVA 2026: STRENGTHENING CAMPUS PARTICIPATION

On September 25th, 2026, under the Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 campaign, IIIT Pune conducted a campus-wide cleanliness drive with active participation from students, faculty, and staff. The activity covered key campus spaces, including grounds, hostels, and common areas, with a focus on maintaining a clean and hygienic institutional environment.

The drive encouraged members of the Institute community to contribute directly to the upkeep of their surroundings and reinforced the importance of responsible waste management, individual accountability, and collective participation. The initiative reflected the spirit of Jan Bhagidari, highlighting that a sustainable and clean campus requires continuous efforts from the entire community.

The activity contributed to SDG 3 (Good Health and Well-being), SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities), and SDG 15 (Life on Land) through its emphasis on hygiene, responsible campus management, and care for the surrounding environment.

The programme translated the principles of Swachhata Hi Seva into meaningful community participation, fostering greater environmental awareness and civic responsibility across the IIIT Pune community.

PLEDGE FOR A CLEANER AND GREENER CAMPUS

In a dedicated effort towards environmental sustainability and collective responsibility, the Indian Institute of Information Technology, Pune organized a Pledge for a Cleaner and Greener Campus, bringing students, faculty, and administration together for a shared cause.

The event marked a significant step in reinforcing eco-conscious practices across the institute. The formal pledge ceremony was inaugurated by the Honorable Director of IIIT Pune, Prof. Vineet Kansal, highlighting the institutional commitment to developing a sustainable, clean, and eco-friendly academic environment.

SAFAIMITRA SURAKSHA EVAM SAMMAN SHIVIR

On October 1st, 2026, as part of the Swachhata Hi Seva 2026 campaign, IIIT Pune organised a SafaiMitra Suraksha Evam Samman Shivir to recognise and engage with the sanitation workers contributing to the cleanliness and hygiene of the campus. The initiative highlighted the importance of waste segregation, responsible waste management, clean water, and composting as key practices for a sustainable campus. It also emphasised the importance of dignity, safety, and respect for sanitation workers and recognised their contribution to the Institute community.

The programme supported SDG 3, Good Health and Well Being, SDG 6, Clean Water and Sanitation, SDG 11, Sustainable Cities and Communities, SDG 12, Responsible Consumption and Production, and SDG 13, Climate Action through its focus on hygiene, sanitation, resource conservation, responsible waste management, and environmental sustainability.

NSS FOUNDATION DAY: COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

On September 24th, 2026, as part of the NSS Foundation Day observance, IIIT Pune undertook a community engagement initiative at Zilla Parishad School, Nanoli Village. The programme brought NSS volunteers together with teachers, health workers, and local residents, providing an opportunity to understand community needs and perspectives while developing greater social awareness.

The interaction reflected the core values of the National Service Scheme and its motto, “Not Me, But You,” by placing community engagement and service at the centre of the initiative.

The activity supported SDG 3, Good Health and Well Being, SDG 4, Quality Education, SDG 10, Reduced Inequalities, and SDG 11, Sustainable Cities and Communities through health awareness, community based learning, inclusive interaction, and participation in local community development.

This initiative allowed IIIT Pune to deepen the connection between education and social responsibility, encouraging students to learn through community service.

SIH INTERNAL ROUNDS

On September 7th, 2026, IIIT Pune hosted its Internal Hackathon to select student teams for the national Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026. Ninety-six teams pitched their solutions to 12 faculty evaluation panels, who rigorously judged the projects based on innovation, feasibility, and technical depth.

The competing students showcased advanced solutions across critical technological domains, including robotics, agentic AI, cybersecurity, deep learning, and explainable AI (XAI). Following this evaluation, the top-performing teams advanced and are now registered on the national SIH portal. Under the guidance of Director Prof. Vineet Kansal, these teams will represent IIIT Pune on the national stage, demonstrating the institute's commitment to solving real-world national challenges.

SPORTS: KABADDI INAUGRATION

IIIT Pune witnessed a rather unusual clash as students and professors stepped out of the classrooms and onto the kabaddi mat. This match was the first of the college's kabaddi tournament inaugurated by the Director Prof. Vineet Kansal on September 26th, 2026. The same professors who challenge students with intellectual problems in the morning, faced their students in a thrilling match on the mat. Beyond the competition, this event brought students and faculty together in the spirit of sportsmanship and fun, making for a memorable start to the tournament.

SPORTS TRIALS

IIIT Pune hosted sports trials for the Inter IIIT Sports Meet 2026, bringing students together to compete, putting their competitive spirit to the test. Students faced each other off in cricket, football, volleyball, basketball, badminton, lawn tennis, table tennis, chess, carrom, athletics, powerlifting, kho-kho, kabaddi, tug of war and swimming, eyeing for a spot in the coveted team which will get to represent IIIT Pune in the upcoming sports meet. The trials hosted over the first week of October were organized by the Sports Club.

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